

Hazrat Hood

The People of Aad

The era of the people of Aad is taken to be a period of two thousand years before the Maseeh and in the Qur'ân the people of Aad being mentioned to be "after the time of Nooh , " seems to indicate that they were the successors of the people of Nooh . In fact they have also been noted to be the "first" people of Aad, and the word of 'Iram' has also been connected to them.

The Area Inhabited

The central point of their residence was the land of 'Ahqauf', which is situated in the north of Hadramount, with Oman to its east and the Rub-'ul-Khaali the empty quarter to the north. Today, however, you will find nothing else in this area except sand and sand hills.

The Religion of Aad

The people of Aad were polytheists, idol-worshippers. In their general profession, like the people of Nabi Nooh  they worshiped these idols and were noted for their sculpture and carving of these idols.

There is a saying by Sayeduna Abdullah bin Abbaas ؓ to the effect that one of there idols was called Samood and another was called Hataar.

Hazrat Nabi Hood ؑ

Because of the power of their country and their pride in their physical strength they considered themselves so highly placed that they completely forgot Allah, their creator, and started worshiping idols, made by their own hands and started performing such *Shaitanic* acts without any fear for Allah until Allah sent to them a messenger chosen from among themselves-Nabi Hood ؑ.

Nabi Hood ؑ was a member from one of their most noble and honoured families and tribes. He was of reddish white colour and a man of dignity, with a big beard.

The Message of Islām

He conveyed the message of Allah's oneness among them and called them all to the worship of Allah, prohibiting them from all injustices and evil. However, the people did not listen to him and refused to heed his call. They rejected him and acted arrogantly towards him, asking him the question:

"Who is there, stronger than as in power?"

(5:41)

In spite of their rejection Nabi Hood ؑ continued to call them towards the obedience to Allah, warning them against the punishment of Allah and explained to them how the people of Nooh ؑ were punished for their disobedience and arrogance. He used to tell them:

"O people be not proud and arrogant over your physical strength and your strong rule over

others, but rather be grateful to Allah for having granted you such wealth and that after the people of Nooh ﷺ He had made you possessors of the earth. He had granted you a good life, removed all worries from you and granted you worldly wealth. So do not forget his bounties and favours. Stop worshiping your own hand made idols, which are not of any benefit to you, and cannot cause you any harm. Life and death, benefit and all harm lie only in the Hands of Allah.

O people, accept the fact that you have disobeyed Him up to now, but even if today repent and return to Him, you know His Mercy is extremely wide and extensive and His doors of repentance are never closed. Seek His forgiveness and He will forgive you. Return to Him and He will grant you pardon and bless you with wealth and honour."

These preaching's of Nabi Hood ﷺ did not go down well with the people and they did not tolerate that any man from among them should accept his ideas, beliefs and deeds or in any way become a follower of his. Thus they decided to jeer and scoff at Nabi Hood ﷺ, calling him a stupid fool and began to reject his truths and reject all his arguments to prove his truth. They said to him:

"O Hood you have not brought to one acceptable argument to prove the truth of your claims, and we are not prepared to leave aside our gods for your sake and neither are we prepared to believe in you."

(5:35)

"And we are not prepared to be caught by your trick to accept you as God's messenger. And we are not prepared to leave aside our Gods and the belief that they will one day be intercessors on our behalf with Allah the great."

Nabi Hood  replied:

"O people, I am not a fool and I am not a mad man. In truth I am Allah's messenger. Allah has not chosen a mad man from among His servants for their guidance. He has chosen me to come to you so that in place of deviation, guidance might spread. For this momentous task he chooses from among His servants such a one who is suitable in all ways and who can deliver this service diligently."

"And Allah knows best where he should place his Messenger ship." (6:124)

However, the obstinate opposition of the people and their intense enmity increased and Nabi Hood (*Alaihis Salām*)'s clear and solid arguments had no effect upon them and there rejection of the truth became even more direct as they called him a mad and insane man, and played the fool with him.

They told him: "We see that since the time that you started to criticize our gods and ordered us to stop worshiping them, from that time your condition has become bad and deteriorated and through the prayers of our gods you have become insane. So as what else should we consider you?" They reckoned that through this kind of insulting words, no one will pay any attention to Nabi Hood  or listen to him with attention.

Nabi Hood عليه السلام heard all these insults with tremendous tolerance and patience and then replied:

"I make Allah my witness and you also as I announce that I am free of this belief that those gods have any power to cause me or anyone else any evil and I challenge those gods that if they have any such power, they should cause me harm. Through the grace of Allah I am a man of reason, a man of perception and wisdom and I only put my reliance in Allah in whose Hands the control of all living beings lies. He is the Lord of life and death and He will surely help me and keep me safe from all harm."

Afterwards after their continuous disobedience and enmity Nabi Hood عليه السلام made this announcement that:

"If that action by the people of Aad was going to continue, and if they were going to continue turn their backs towards his preachings and if no changes were going to come forth from their sides, and they were not going to heed my advices to them then in spite of the fact that I am at all times prepared to carry on the services which had been handed over to me, then most, certainly destruction was going to be the end result of your deeds. Very soon Allah will destroy them and will bring in their place another nation. They will not be able to cause Allah any harm because Allah has power and sovereignty over all things and the whole Universe is subservient to His power."

"O people, make use of your reasoning faculties. Take a lesson from what happened to the people of Nooh ﷺ and become subservient to Allah's commands. The Hand of predestined fate has already become clear. It is near at hand that your arrogance and pride will be mixed in the sand of the earth. When that time comes, there will be no other result except sorrow and regret and regret will then be of no use."

Nabi Hood ﷺ repeatedly tried to make them believe. "I am not your enemy. I am a friend of yours. I am not seeking wealth or position, but am interested in your salvation and success. I am not a deceiver as for as Allah's message is concerned, but a faithful and trustworthy conveyer thereof. I only convey to you what was told to me. And whatever I tell you, is for your own good fortune and is said for your everlasting salvation."

"You should not wonder that Allah's message should descend upon one of your people before from ancient times this has been Allah's *Sunnat* that for the sake of man's salvation and guidance one from among them is chosen who is made a messenger and addressed to inform him of Allah's pleasure and what causes His displeasure. Logic also demands that for the guidance of men such a person be chosen who is like them in speech and action, who knows their character and manners and is aware of their special features, and who has lived among them to whom they should feel attracted so that he can be their true guide with their interests at heart."

When and heard this, they were perplexed as they could not understand as to how they were to worship one God. How were they to discard all the gods of their fore fathers. This infuriated them. That would be a great insult to their

fore fathers. In anger they retorted how can those fore fathers now be declared polytheists and idol worshipers and non-believers in view of the fact that those gods were intercessors with Allah?

According to them belief in Hood عليه السلام would mean an insult to their fore fathers and the gods, whom they accepted as a *Wassilah* and intercessors in the presence of Allah, and for this reason they worshiped these idols and pictures that the idols would become pleased and intercede on their behalf with Allah so that they could be saved from the punishment of Allah.

At last they rose up in anger against Nabi Hood عليه السلام and annoyed with him, said to him: "You have threatened us with the punishment of your Lord and have frightened us by saying:

"I fear for you of the coming of the punishment of a great day (that you become worthy of it).

(26:135)

"O Hood your advices will now not be heeded. If you are truly true in your words, then hastily bring on the punishment that your and our affair be settled."

"So bring to us what you threatened as with if indeed you tell the truth."

(7:70)

Nabi Hood عليه السلام replied:

"If that is your reply to my sincere and truthful advices, and you wish for the punishment to come, then know that punishment is not for away."

"Verily the punishment and anger of your Lord has arrived."

(7:71)

"You people are not ashamed that you call upon a few idols formed by your own hands whose names you have fabricated and whom your fore fathers have believe to be their intercessors without any proof from Allah and now you turn away from my clear proofs and arguments, asking for Allah's punishment to come. If you are so eager for it to come, then wait for it for I shall also await it. The time for it is indeed near at hand."

The Qur'ān states:

"Dispute you with me over names you have devised you and your fathers without authority from Allah?"

Then wait, I am amongst you, also waiting.

(7:71)

The Punishment

Finally after the intense disobedience of the tribe of Aad, the people of Hood عليه السلام and their rejection and enmity against the preachings of Nabi Hood عليه السلام, and as a result of the retribution of their actions and the time came for their punishment. The anger of Allah was stirred and from Allah's side a great drought descended upon the land. This caused them great concern and discomfort and they appeared quite helpless and destitute.

At this stage a great feeling of sympathy for them in Nabi Hood عليه السلام once again incited him to call them to the path of truth after previous disappointment. He again called them to believe in his advices as the only way towards salvation in this world and the here after; otherwise they will

regret it. But again his call was in vain and had no effect upon them. In fact their rejection and enmity increased even more. Hence thereafter a dreadful punishment descended. For eight days and seven nights a terrible strong wind blew over them and flattened everything among them. At that time strong and well-built men who used to be proud of their strength and their disobedience, appeared so devoid of senses and movements as the strong wind brought down strong trees and uprooted them. All of them were removed from the surface of the earth, to become a sign of warning for future generations. The curse of this world and the next was let loose among them and set over them while Nabi Nooh ﷺ and the small group who followed him were saved from the hurricane through Allah's mercy and grace. This is the story of the first Aad which holds in itself a great lesson and which is a call from Allah to mankind to follow his instructions. It warns against the disobedience and rebellion against the orders of Allah and against the unfortunate results of arrogant over temporary time of wealth living.

The Death of Nabi Hood ﷺ

It is reported by Sayeduna Ali ؑ that Nabi Hood (Alaihis Salām)'s grave is in Hadramout at a place called Kasheef Ahmar. At the headside of the grave is a *Jhau* tree. This report seems to be correct and it seems sensible because the habit at of the people of Aad ؑ was near Hadramout and he continued to live near there after his people were destroyed and it seems logical that he might have passed away there.

Lessons

When Allah's chosen servants is appointed to reform the condition of a people, and proceeds to advise them on

the right path, he does not pay attention to the Jeering and scoffing of those very ones for whose welfare he acts. Such a servant does not become disheartened and infuriated and discard his good deed in their welfare. Above all a most important point in this regard is this that he does not ask for any benefit for himself, no does he expect any form of remuneration from them. His way of life continues to be superior and above theirs.

The Main cause for the hatred and enmity of the people against the Prophets and reformers has always been this that criticism has been expressed against the customs of the forefathers and their self-made idols. This evil has always been very destructive for the spiritual life of people and has always been a great stumbling block towards their everlasting prosperity and success.

In the field of conveying Allah's message one should always exchange good for evil and in response to harsh talk one should always give sweet words in reply.

However, the conveying messenger when faced with continuous rejection and rebellious obstinacy should also remind them of the Divine law of 'retribution' and make them aware of the results of evil. Hence if there is continuous general rejection and evil deeds from their side, then in the end the wrath and anger of Allah will come into motion and bring destruction upon them.

The Mention in the Qur'ān

The story of 'Nabi Hood ﷺ is mentioned in *Surah A'raaf, Hood and Shu'araa*. The people of Aad is also mentioned in *Surah A'raaf, Hood, Muminoon, Shu'araa, Fussilat, Ahqaaf, At-Thahiiyaat, Al-Qamar, Al-Haaqqah*.

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

By: Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Ra)

Translated by: Maulana Yusuf Karaan



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New Delhi-110 025 (India)

Tel.: +91-11-2695 6832 & 085888 33786

Fax: +91-11-6617 3545 Email: sales@idara.co

Online Store: www.idarastore.com

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Shop 6, Nizamia Complex, Gali Gadrian, Hazrat Nizamuddin
New Delhi-110013 (India) Tel.: 085888 44786

Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

Allamah Binori Town, Karachi

P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
Strand, South Africa